

Pre-Lecture Analysis Sheet

Week 3 · Pulse Diagnosis 脈診 — 28 Qualities, Positions, Seasonal Pulses

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How to use this sheet:

Before lecture → complete Sections A-D and the pre-lecture case questions. Rate your confidence honestly.

During lecture → annotate directly — add answers, corrections, and new insights in the lined spaces.

After lecture → complete Section F, update confidence ratings, and finish the clinical case.

Name: _____ Date: _____

EAM310

Week 3

Summer 2026

A · Learning Targets — I Can Statements

Rate your confidence before lecture (Pre) and after lecture (Post) by circling a number 1-5. 1 = can't do it yet · 5 = fully confident

I Can Statement	Pre-Lecture Confidence	Post-Lecture Confidence
Name the three qualities of a normal pulse (Stomach-Qi, Spirit, Root) and explain what each reflects physiologically.	Pre 1 2 3 4 5 Post 1 2 3 4 5	Pre 1 2 3 4 5 Post 1 2 3 4 5
Locate all six cun-guan-chi positions (left and right) and state the organ assigned to each.	Pre 1 2 3 4 5 Post 1 2 3 4 5	Pre 1 2 3 4 5 Post 1 2 3 4 5
Classify all 28 pulse qualities into their six groupings (Depth, Rate, Strength, Size, Length, Shape, Rhythm).	Pre 1 2 3 4 5 Post 1 2 3 4 5	Pre 1 2 3 4 5 Post 1 2 3 4 5
Discriminate Knotted, Hasty, and Intermittent pulses by rate and regularity of stops.	Pre 1 2 3 4 5 Post 1 2 3 4 5	Pre 1 2 3 4 5 Post 1 2 3 4 5
State the normal seasonal pulse for all four seasons including date ranges (Wiry / Flooding / Hair-like / Stone-like).	Pre 1 2 3 4 5 Post 1 2 3 4 5	Pre 1 2 3 4 5 Post 1 2 3 4 5
Given a clinical presentation, predict the expected pulse quality and confirm it at the correct organ position.	Pre 1 2 3 4 5 Post 1 2 3 4 5	Pre 1 2 3 4 5 Post 1 2 3 4 5

B · Activate — Connect to What You Know

B1 · From Week 2 to Today

Week 2 covered the Eight Principles and introduced tongue and pulse positions. Today Week 3 goes deep on the 28 pulse qualities — you will learn to feel what each quality describes, what pattern it indicates, and how position × quality together produce a diagnosis.

What do you already know about pulse diagnosis? Write whatever comes to mind:

B2 · Connect the Dots

How do each of these prior-week concepts connect to today's pulse content?

Eight Principles: Exterior pattern → what pulse quality would you expect at the surface? 	Cold vs. Heat → which produces Slow pulse and which Rapid? Why?
Qi Deficiency (Week 1) → which pulse quality most likely? Why? 	Phlegm / Dampness → what is the classic pulse quality? (Hint: Week 2 quick ref)

C · Vocabulary Pre-Load — Define Before Class

Fill in your definition / feel / mnemonic before lecture. Refine during and after class. Blank = opportunity to learn it live.

Character	Pinyin	English	My Definition / Feel / Clinical Note
脈診	Mài Zhěn	Pulse Diagnosis	
浮脈	Fú Mài	Floating Pulse	
沉脈	Chén Mài	Deep Pulse	
遲脈	Chí Mài	Slow Pulse	
數脈	Shuò Mài	Rapid Pulse	

Character	Pinyin	English	My Definition / Feel / Clinical Note
滑脈	Huá Mài	Slippery Pulse	
澀脈	Sè Mài	Choppy Pulse	
弦脈	Xián Mài	Wiry Pulse	
緊脈	Jǐn Mài	Tight Pulse	
芤脈	Kōu Mài	Hollow Pulse	
結脈	Jié Mài	Knotted Pulse	
促脈	Cù Mài	Hasty Pulse	
代脈	Dài Mài	Intermittent Pulse	
胃氣	Wèi Qì	Stomach-Qi (in pulse)	
寸關尺	Cùn Guān Chǐ	Three Pulse Positions	

D · Anticipatory Questions — Answer During Lecture

Leave blank before lecture — fill in the answers as the material is covered. Expand after class.

Normal Pulse & Positions 正常脈 · 脈位

Q1 · THE THREE QUALITIES OF A NORMAL PULSE ★

What are the three essential qualities every normal pulse must have, and what does each one reflect about the patient’s fundamental health?
Hint: Three qualities — not four. Which reflects the Heart? The Kidney? Slide 172.

Q2 · THE SIX POSITIONS ★

Complete the pulse position table — try from memory first, then verify from the lecture:

Position	Left Hand — Organ(s)	Right Hand — Organ(s)
寸 Cun (1st · Index)		
關 Guan (2nd · Middle)		
尺 Chi (3rd · Ring)		

Depth, Rate & Shape

Q3 · FLOATING VS. DEEP — AND THEIR COMBINATIONS ★

What does a Floating pulse indicate? What changes the meaning when combined with Empty at depth? Then: what does Deep + Weak indicate vs. Deep + Full?
Hint: Floating also indicates Yin def when Empty at depth. Slides 177–181.

Q4 · RAPID & SLOW COMBINATIONS ★

Rapid + Full vs. Rapid + Empty — explain both. Then Slow + Weak vs. Slow + Full.
Hint: Full-Heat vs. Empty-Heat; Empty-Cold vs. Full-Cold. Slides 182–185.

Q5 · WIRY VS. TIGHT ★

Both feel taut. What is the textural difference — and what does each primarily indicate? When is Wiry completely normal?
Hint: Wiry = bowstring; Tight = twisted rope. One has a seasonal context. Slides 203–206.

Rhythm Irregulars & Seasonal Pulses

Q6 · KNOTTED / HASTY / INTERMITTENT ★★

Fill in during lecture:

Pulse	Rate	Stops are...	Primary Indication	Severity
Knotted 結				
Hasty 促				
Intermittent 代				

Q7 · HOLLOW PULSE ★

Describe the three-level finding of the Hollow pulse and the clinical emergency it signals.

Hint: Present at surface + deep, empty in middle. Like pressing a scallion stalk. Slide 209.

Q8 · SEASONAL PULSES — ALL FOUR ★★ (SCHRIER: "GOOD QUIZ QUESTION — WINK WINK NUDGE NUDGE")

Fill in each season's expected normal pulse AND date range during lecture:

Season	Date Range	Normal Pulse Quality	Physiological Rationale (Yang Qi movement)
Spring 春			
Summer 夏			
Autumn 秋			
Winter 冬			

Q9 · SIX CLIMATIC QI → PULSE SIGNATURES

Which pulse does each pathogen produce? Fill in from the Seasonal Pulses slide deck:

Pathogen (六淫)	Expected Pulse Quality
Wind 風	
Cold 寒	
Summer-Heat 暑	
Dampness 濕	
Dryness 燥	
Fire / Heat 火	

Q10 · POSITION + QUALITY = DIAGNOSIS

A Wiry pulse only at Left Guan means something very different from Wiry everywhere. Why does position matter as much as quality? What would Left Guan Wiry specifically suggest?

Hint: Left Guan = Liver/Gallbladder. Position localizes the pattern to the organ.

E · Clinical Case — Apply It Before & After

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Case Vignette: Ms. Lin, 34-year-old competitive Latin dancer

Ms. Lin presents with a **3-month history of chronic fatigue and lower back soreness**. She trains 6 days/week, 4–5 hours per session. She reports **dizziness when standing quickly, blurred vision, dry eyes**, and **night sweats**. She is rarely thirsty; prefers room-temperature water. Her menstrual cycle is irregular — **periods are late and scanty**. Examination: tongue is **pale and slightly dry, thin coat**. You palpate her radial pulse.

Fatigue 3 mo

Low back soreness

Dizziness on standing

Night sweats

Blurred vision · dry eyes

Scanty late periods

Tongue: pale, slightly dry

Room-temp water

Pre-Lecture Questions — Answer Based on Your Current Knowledge

Before the lecture, do your best with these. Guessing is fine — it primes your brain to receive the lecture material.

PRE · Q1

What pulse quality or qualities would you most expect to feel in Ms. Lin — and at which position(s)? Explain your reasoning.

PRE · Q2

Using Eight Principles from Week 2: Interior or Exterior? Deficiency or Excess? What evidence supports your answer?

PRE · Q3

Night sweats + blurred vision in a young female dancer — name the pattern you suspect and the Vital Substance most likely depleted.

Post-Lecture Questions — Complete After Class

POST · Q1

State the specific pulse quality you would expect at each of Ms. Lin's six positions. Explain what pattern each finding points to. (Use cun/guan/chi × left/right format.)

POST · Q2

Which of the 28 pulse qualities did today's lecture make most relevant to Ms. Lin's case? Name the quality, its feel, and what it confirms about her pattern.

POST · Q3

Ms. Lin's night sweats occur around 1–3 AM (Liver/GB time). How does this interact with her pulse findings, and what treatment principle would the pulse support?

F · After-Lecture Synthesis & Self-Monitoring

Complete this section within 24 hours of lecture for maximum retention.

I Can Now Confidently...	Still Unclear — I Need to Review...	Connected to Other Learning...

Concept Map Completion — 28 Pulse Qualities by Classification

Complete the table from memory. Fill in the qualities and what property each group measures.

Classification Group	Pulse Qualities in This Group	Core Property Measured
Depth		
Rate		
Strength		
Size		
Length		
Shape		
Rhythm		

Homework Tracker

Assigned Homework (from lecture):

- ☐ **Task 1:** Practice pulse-taking on at least 3 people before next class. Record depth, rate, strength, quality, and position-specific findings using the 6-position grid. Write up as Pulse/Tongue Journal entries.
- ☐ **Task 2:** Complete Pulse/Tongue Journal entries for this week. Tongue map + full 6-position pulse grid on every page. Entries 1-25 due at Midterm (Aug 7).
- ☐ **Task 3:** Quiz 3 prep — reproduce all 28 quality names, feels, and indications from memory. Practice seasonal pulse mnemonic until automatic. Quiz 3 is July 31.

Notes on practice / logistics: